

SLOPPY - Meeting Task - Increasing vs. Flat (#171843)

Author(s)

This pre-registration is currently anonymous to enable blind peer-review.
It has one author.

Pre-registered on: 04/22/2024 11:07 AM (PT)

1) Have any data been collected for this study already?

No, no data have been collected for this study yet.

2) What's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?

In a cue-learning task in which none of the cues influence the outcomes, people who learned in the presence of a positive exogenous trend (vs. no trend) will be more confident that the cues did have an influence the outcomes.

3) Describe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.

We will measure two dependent variables:

- a) Participant's belief that the cues influenced the outcomes. This DV is the average of four items: "Changing the meeting practices had an impact on the performance of the team", "Some meeting practices resulted in better performance than others", "Overall, meeting practices mattered for the performance of the team", "The performance of the team didn't seem to be affected by meeting practices" (reverse-coded), all measured on 5-point scales ("Strongly disagree", "Somewhat disagree", "Neither agree nor disagree", "Somewhat agree", "Strongly agree")
- b) Subjective likelihood that "best" practices will outperform "worst" practices. Participants will describe what they believe are the "best" and "worst" meeting practices. They will then report the probability that a random team using the "best" meeting practices will outperform a random team using the "worst" meeting practices, on a 50-100% scale (in 5% increments). This measure is incentive-compatible: The participants who give the correct answer (50%) will be entered a lottery to win 100GBP.

4) How many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?

The only condition of interest is the trend of the outcomes: Participants will be randomly assigned to the "Increasing" condition (in which outcomes tend to increase over time) or the "Flat" condition.

In addition, the outcomes that participants see in each of these conditions will be randomly chosen out of five different replicates. We do not expect any impact of this factor.

5) Specify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.

We will compare our two dependent variables using independent sample t-tests.

6) Describe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for excluding observations.

We will measure the amount of time participants spend on the cue-learning task, and exclude all participants who completed the task in less than 50 seconds.

7) How many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size? No need to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.

In the hope of reaching 300 valid participants after exclusions, we will collect 330 responses.

8) Anything else you would like to pre-register? (e.g., secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)

We will conduct exploratory analysis on the choice patterns of participants during the game. Specifically, we will check if participants in the "Increasing" condition were quicker to converge on a set of attributes (defined by the number of attributes that participants change from one week to another, between 0 and 4) as the game went on.

We will also explore participants' beliefs in what are "best" and "worst" meeting practices. If participants do not have strong priors, we should expect to see that a good number of the 108 possible combinations are represented in the participants' answers.